CARISSA QURESHI

Political Science & Criminology · Prospective M.A., International Relations

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4.0 GPA
North Central College · Double Major, Political Science & Criminology

2× TEAM USA
Represented the U.S. on the U20 World Team, 2024 & 2025

SILVER
2025 U20 Pan-American Championships

PROFILE

Political science and criminology student preparing to study how institutions, law, and governance shape security and justice across borders. A two-time U.S. U20 World Team member, I have represented the United States internationally while excelling academically, and I bring policy research and writing skills grounded in criminal justice reform work.

EDUCATION

North Central College · Naperville, IL — Aug 2025 – May 2027 (expected)
B.A., Political Science & Criminology (Double Major) · GPA 4.0
Major research: *"Effect of Red-Pill Content on Young Men and Their Gendered Worldview"*

University of Colorado Colorado Springs (UCCS) — Jan 2025 – Aug 2025
Political Science coursework · GPA 4.0

Golden West College · Huntington Beach, CA — Aug 2023 – Dec 2024
Psychology coursework · GPA 3.80

INTERNATIONAL ATHLETIC EXPERIENCE

U.S. National Team Athlete, Women's Freestyle Wrestling — 2023 – 2025
USA Wrestling · United World Wrestling (UWW)

- Represented the U.S. at the 2024 (Spain) and 2025 (Bulgaria) U20 World Championships, fields of 650 wrestlers from 50+ nations; placed 10th in 2025.
- Won silver at the 2025 U20 Pan-American Championships after winning the 2024 U.S. U20 World Team Trials.

USA Wrestling Elite Accelerator Program (EAP) · Invited Athlete — 2025
U.S. Olympic & Paralympic Training Center · Colorado Springs, CO

- Invited by USA Wrestling to its national development program for top emerging athletes; trained 20 hours per week while earning a 4.0 GPA at UCCS.
- Featured in USA Wrestling's EAP documentary series on athlete training and development.

NCAA Division III Women's Wrestling · North Central College — Aug 2025 – Present

- Balance a full NCAA competition and travel schedule with a double major and a 4.0 GPA.

RESEARCH, POLICY & SERVICE

Intern, Stateville Speaks · Illinois — Sep 2026 – Present

- Research legislation and policy affecting incarcerated people, translating it and contributors' firsthand perspectives into accessible newsletter content.
- Manage correspondence and records for 2,000 subscribers, ensuring accurate distribution inside correctional facilities.

Student Mentor, Partners for Success — Oct 2026 – Present

- Mentor youth through illustration journaling, building confidence through one-on-one support.

Youth Coach & Mentor, Orange County RTC & Premier Wrestling — Jan 2021 – Apr 2024

- Coached athletes ages 7–16, partnered with families on accountability and discipline, and refereed youth tournaments.

INTERNATIONAL EXPERIENCE

Countries
Spain · Sweden · Peru · Bulgaria · Japan

Team USA Selections
U20 World Teams, 2024 & 2025

International Competitions
UWW U20 World Championships (2024, 2025) · U20 Pan-American Championships (2025)

RELEVANT COURSEWORK

International Relations · Criminal Justice · Scope of Political Science · Quantitative Research Methods

RESEARCH SKILLS

Qualitative & quantitative methods · Legal & policy research · Literature reviews · Survey design & administration · Policy writing

TOOLS

SPSS (statistical analysis) · Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Outlook · Google Workspace · Canva